Moth's Ascent Game Design Document

By: Team whimsy

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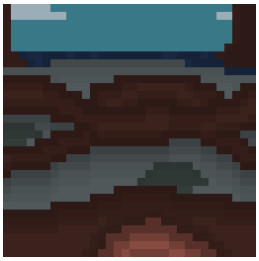

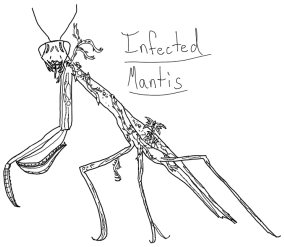

Genre: Psychological-Horror, Absurdist Narrative	Platform: PC	Team size: 4

Theme: Our story follows the growth of our character, who evolves from a bug into a sentient being over the course of a century. The focus on character growth perfectly aligns with the topic of metamorphosis as the player experiences this transformation. After the passage of time, their surroundings have become decrepit with unknown, absurdist horrors in its wake. Now awakened from their slumber, our character must chase their newfound purpose to save The Lost Forest of Whim and fight against its impending doom.

Key Points:

- ***After waking up from a sleep since the last game Worm's Wake, the player must now traverse through The Lost Forest of Whim in search of the cause of the ever growing disease/rot that plagues the life of the forest.***
- ***As the player explores the forest, they run into many different hostile plants, animals, and bugs and must use their metamorphosis to their advantage in order to fight against them.***
- ***The player will choose what they want to metamorphosize towards, allowing for unique abilities and attacks that can cater towards their playstyle in the turn-based combat.***
- ***Rewards for winning fights along with the metamorphosis include things like health regen, maybe a consumable item, etc. to assist with the next fight. These can be scaled depending on how well the player did in the last combat.***
- ***The final encounter will hold a boss that guards the secret to the forest's plague, and upon beating him, will transition the story to our next game***

Brief Overview:

Our game Moth's Ascent takes place in the Lost Forest of Whim, a magical realm created by the Goddess of Twists and Turns after a long slumber. The hostile infection that had begun to plague some of the wildlife in Worm's Wake has now spread much further and is beginning to plague all of the life in the forest. With an ever changing physique, the player must use their metamorphosis in order to gain new abilities to use to fight the hostile life that resides in the swampish wasteland that the plate has found themself in.

Strategic gameplay in the turn-based fights will be rewarded through health and items that can assist the player in the next fight, or be held onto for the final boss that guards the source of the infection. During fighting downtime, the player learns more about the infection and experiences first hand the types of changes it can cause in a creature.

Timeline

Category	Task	Date	Assigned to	Status
Menu UI Functionality/ Programming	Code script menus/script (Save, Pause, Start, Death)	Beta: 2/19	Dani	Brainstorming/reviewing what we want in the menus
Art/Design	Create pixel art for unique sprites and assets	Beta: 2/24	Dominic	Starting to make sprites with Aesprite
Gameplay/Interface	Create a script for a turn-based attack system and user exploration	Beta: 2/19	Hope	Created skeletons of classes, in the process of adding basic functionality
Mechanics Design	Create gameplay loop and abilities aspects	Beta: 2/17	Everyone	Defined general design
Narrative/Story Writing/Dialogue	Layout/Create narrative and story progression	Beta (intro dialogue): 2/18	Ethan	Brainstorming / Forming starts

Art / Design	UI art, icons, etc	Beta: 2/24	Dominic	Starting to make sprites with Aesprite
Sound Design	Collect sound assets and implement them into the game	Beta: 2/24	Hope	Explore Unity Asset Store and other resources for sound effects and music